

A Shift in Focus: From Intellectual Metrics to Authentic Living

A Personal Reflection

I find I have lost a significant amount of interest in relentless intellectual growth, primarily because I feel I've reached a point of diminishing marginal returns. There was a time when every new concept or line of research felt like a breakthrough, but that feeling has faded. Now, the effort required for "mindless" expansion feels disproportionate to the reward. My focus has honestly shifted, moving away from the abstract and toward the tangible. I now want to prioritize my physical balance and fitness, feeling grounded in my own body.

This new focus is taking practical form. I have started going for very long walks, not as a form of exercise, but as a way to be present and observe the world without an agenda. I am also trying to learn the local language, not for any professional gain, but to simply interact with the people living here, to connect on a basic, human level.

While I am still preparing for a competitive exam, the all-consuming hunger for hard research is gone. My main call now is to settle down intellectually and simply enjoy my life—because I need to **live** my life, not just analyze it. I have consciously stopped looking at external metrics for success. While I still check my accounts and other practical things, I no longer obsess over having so many followers, such a high ranking, or how influential my work is. That constant chase for validation is exhausting. What matters to me now is that I live every day, not just surviving, but doing what I want to do, living in the moment.

At this age, I am lucky to have already built a solid intellectual foundation for myself. I have systems and automation that streamline many processes in my life. My finances, for example, are now a habit; I have optimized my life to the point where I no longer have to consciously manage many of these tasks. This foundation is not a trophy; it is a tool. It is what allows me the freedom to make this shift, to step back from the machine without everything falling apart.

This foundation is what allows me to make this shift. I am no longer interested in having the perfect words to say, using the most eloquent language, or putting on a show for everyone else to see. That performance is a cage. I just want to be authentic. I want to be human. I don't mind a lack of polish; in fact, I want to be "messy." I want to make mistakes and screw up in ways that are not deadly for me. I've realized that if I am always on my feet trying to find the perfect word or the perfect logic in everything, I am no longer interested in life itself. The pursuit of perfection was isolating me from the very life I claimed to be building.

I do not enjoy the "figure" I made for myself. I am tired of the performance. I wish to live more like a common man, not as a person defined by my background. This is why I am consciously offloading a lot of my cognitive burden to artificial intelligence. I trust that I can always refer to it for facts, for polish, for the "perfect" phrasing if I ever truly need it. This allows me to stop training myself to use the perfect word in a casual conversation. It frees me to be myself, to fool around with friends, and to speak without worrying about perfect grammar. It allows me to reserve my finite mental energy for only the most important decisions.

I am not saying I will never learn anything new again. But that specific, driven, and somewhat anxious hunger is no longer for me. I am intentionally doing less of that which is complicated. I am shifting gears to a more settled life, one where I can be present, authentic, and, for the lack of a better word,

human.